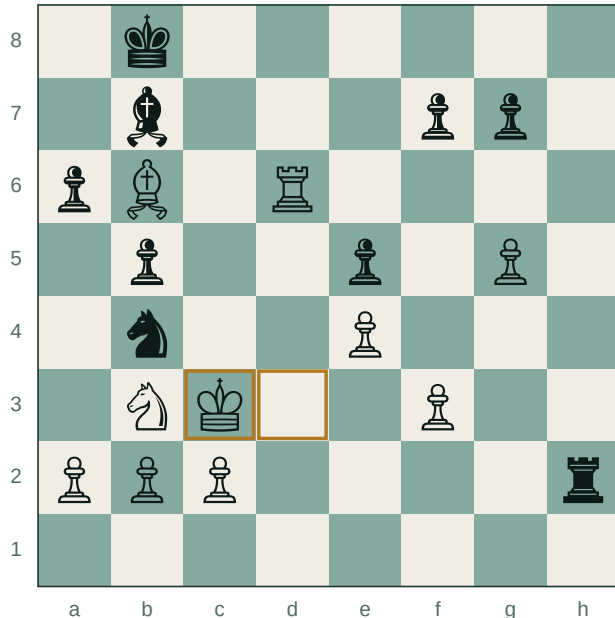


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 27

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Kc3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Rxc2+ 28. Kxb4 Rc4+ 29. Ka3 Ra4#

27...Rxc2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on c2. Recorded reply: **28.Kxb4**.

28...Rc4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29.Ka3**.

29...Ra4# Mate: rook on a4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on c3. Geometrically undefended: rook on d6. Check for tactical protection.